

KAMAL MAHER

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Research interests: Multi-agent systems · Evals · Interpretability · Biosecurity

EDUCATION

- 2020 – 2025 | **MIT**, PHD IN COMPUTATIONAL BIOLOGY
Thesis: Fundamental representations of regions and interactions in spatial transcriptomics
Advisor: Xiao Wang
- 2014 – 2018 | **Cornell University**, BS IN NEUROSCIENCE

EXPERIENCE

- 2026 – | **SecureBio**, SENIOR RESEARCH FELLOW (VIA PIVOTAL)
• Building a multi-agent system that automatically designs evaluations of biological capabilities in frontier models.
- 2025 – 2026 | **SPAR**, RESEARCH FELLOW
• Built an agent that iteratively probes and explains learned representations in large language models, improving feature explanation accuracy by 7.7% over existing methods. [1]
• Demonstrated that a widely-used mechanistic interpretability method is incentivized to learn unfaithful explanations of neural network computation. [2]
- 2021 – 2025 | **MIT**, GRADUATE RESEARCHER
• Developed a spectral graph framework for spatial transcriptomics and applied it to a 1.09M cell mouse brain atlas, revealing transcriptional gradients and regions absent from established anatomical references. [3]
- 2024 | **Genentech**, AVIV REGEV LAB INTERN
• Extended the same framework to cancer spatial transcriptomics, identifying tumor regions and cell–cell interactions more efficiently than existing GNN-based approaches.

SELECT PUBLICATIONS (*equal contribution)

- [1] *Multi-shot AutoInterp: Agents Can Explain Complex Features By Refining Explanations.*
K. Maher*, S.E. Schrader*, K. Ayonrinde
ICLR 2026 Workshop on Unifying Concept Representation Learning. 2026
- [2] *Cross-Layer Transcoders are Incentivized to Learn Unfaithful Circuits.*
G. Lange, R. Goldstein, **K. Maher**, K. Dearstyne
ICML 2026 Mechanistic Interpretability Workshop. 2026 (Spotlight)
- [3] *Spatial Atlas of the Mouse Central Nervous System at Molecular Resolution.*
H. Shi*, Y. He*, Y. Zhou*, J. Huang, **K. Maher**, B. Wang, Z. Tang, S. Luo, P. Tan, M. Wu, Z. Lin, J. Ren, Y. Thapa, X. Tang, K.Y. Chan, B.E. Deverman, H. Shen, A. Liu, J. Liu, X. Wang
Nature. 2023